HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "If I talk about it, I will fall apart, so I have to keep it locked inside."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"If I talk about it, I will fall apart, so I have to keep it locked inside." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What am I afraid will happen if I say one sentence, not the whole story?
- ☐ Have I ever said a little and remained myself afterward?
- ☐ Who is actually safe enough for a small truth?
- ☐ Do I have permission, including from myself, to stop?
- ☐ What kind of comfort does Scripture describe, and does it require a full account?
- ☐ What pace has my counselor offered?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ I do not have to tell everything. One careful sentence, with a safe person or my counselor, does not have to make me fall apart.
- ☐ Silence kept me going, and it does not have to be my only tool.
- ☐ I choose what to say, and when, and to whom.
- ☐ God comforts. He does not force my story out of me.
- ☐ A counselor can help me say a little without being flooded.
- ☐ Feeling stirred is not the same as falling apart.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 1:3–4
  *"Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our troubles, so that we can comfort those in any trouble with the comfort we ourselves have received from God."*
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."*
- ☐ Romans 12:15
  *"Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When talking felt like it would undo you: Each day, write down one moment when a single word felt too dangerous. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, 2 Corinthians 1:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God is the God of comfort. I can say a little, and I can stop.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Help" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.*

- [ ] Do not start with the story. With your counselor, practice saying only "This is hard to talk about." Stop there if you need to.
- [ ] Agree on a stop signal with your counselor or a safe person before any harder conversation.
- [ ] Write one sentence you are willing to say, with no graphic detail, and decide later whether to share it.
- [ ] After any conversation, do something ordinary that reminds you that you did not disappear.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I talk about it, I will fall apart, so I have to keep it locked inside.": _____ %  My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | A word I survived saying |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

**THE LIE**

~~If I talk about it, I will fall apart, so I have to keep it locked inside~~

**THE TRUTH**

**GOD'S WORD**

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I am afraid that speaking will undo me. You are the God of comfort. Give me a safe person, a slow pace, and the freedom to say a little and then stop. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*